



Safer Recruitment Policy

Company Name: SwiftPath SEN Education

Directors: Talal Yazbik, Zahir Azam

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL): Talal Yazbik

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Review Date: 25 May 2027

1. Policy Statement

SwiftPath SEN Education is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children and young people. We recognise that safer recruitment practices are essential in preventing unsuitable individuals from working with children.

We follow a robust and consistent recruitment process to ensure that all candidates placed in education settings are safe, suitable, and appropriately qualified.

This policy applies to all staff, contractors, and candidates supplied by SwiftPath SEN Education.

2. Purpose of This Policy

The purpose of this policy is to ensure:

- All staff are recruited safely and appropriately
- Safeguarding is embedded throughout the recruitment process
- All legal and regulatory requirements are met
- Only suitable individuals are placed in schools and education settings

3. Legal & Guidance Framework

This policy is aligned with:

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE)
- Working Together to Safeguard Children
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006

- Equality Act 2010
- Immigration, Asylum and Nationality Act 2006
- DBS Code of Practice

4. Safer Recruitment Principles

SwiftPath SEN Education follows these core principles:

- The safety of children is the highest priority
- All staff are vetted before placement
- Recruitment is consistent, fair, and transparent
- No candidate is placed without full compliance checks
- All gaps in employment are investigated and verified

5. Recruitment Process Overview

All candidates must complete the following steps before placement:

Step 1: Application

Candidates must provide:

- Full employment history
 - Education and qualifications
 - Personal details
 - Work references
 - Disclosure of criminal history (where applicable)
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Step 2: Identity Verification

We verify identity using official documents such as:

- Passport
 - Driving licence
 - Visa / share code (if applicable)
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Step 3: Right to Work in the UK

We confirm legal entitlement to work in the UK in accordance with Home Office guidance.

No candidate will be engaged without valid right to work documentation.

Step 4: DBS Checks

All candidates must hold:

- Enhanced DBS certificate
- Children's barred list check (where applicable)

DBS checks must be:

- Clear or risk-assessed
- Valid and verified before placement

Where necessary, new DBS applications will be processed before assignment.

Step 5: Employment References

A minimum of **two professional references** must be obtained, including:

- Most recent employer
- One safeguarding-related reference where possible

References must:

- Cover at least the last 2 years
 - Be verified directly (not accepted by candidate submission alone)
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Step 6: Employment History Checks

We will review:

- Full employment history
- Any gaps in employment
- Reasons for leaving roles

Any gaps must be explained and documented.

Step 7: Qualification Verification

All relevant qualifications must be checked and verified.

Examples:

- Teaching Assistant qualifications
 - SEN training certificates
 - Degree certificates (if applicable)
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Step 8: Safeguarding Screening

Candidates will be assessed for:

- Suitability to work with children
 - Professional conduct
 - Behavioural concerns
 - Social media suitability (where necessary)
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Step 9: Interview / Screening

All candidates will undergo a structured screening process which includes:

- Professional experience review
 - Safeguarding awareness questions
 - Behavioural suitability assessment
 - Communication assessment
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6. Risk Assessment (Where Required)

If any concerns arise (e.g. DBS notes, employment gaps, unclear references), a formal risk assessment will be completed by the DSL before placement.

A candidate may still be placed only if deemed safe and appropriate.

7. Safeguarding Commitment

SwiftPath SEN Education ensures:

- No candidate is placed without full clearance
- All safeguarding concerns are escalated immediately
- Schools are informed of any relevant risk factors
- Candidate suitability is continuously monitored

8. Ongoing Monitoring

After placement, we ensure:

- Continued suitability of staff
- Feedback is collected from schools
- Any incidents are reviewed immediately
- Candidates remain compliant with safeguarding expectations

9. Record Keeping

We maintain secure records of:

- DBS certificates
- References
- Identity checks
- Right to work documents
- Interview notes
- Risk assessments

All records are stored securely in compliance with GDPR.

10. Equality & Fair Recruitment

SwiftPath SEN Education ensures all recruitment is:

- Fair
- Non-discriminatory
- Based on suitability and competence only

We comply with the Equality Act 2010.

11. Responsibility

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL): Talal Yazbik

Responsible for:

- Final approval of candidates
- Safeguarding compliance
- Risk assessments

Co-Director: Zahir Azam

Responsible for:

- Operational oversight
- Recruitment process support

12. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if required due to:

- Changes in legislation
- Updates to KCSIE guidance
- Operational changes within the business

13. Declaration & Approval

This policy is approved and adopted by SwiftPath SEN Education.

Director: Talal Yazbik

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Director: Zahir Azam

Signature: _____ Date: _____